



7-Figure NIL & Digital Reputation Matrix

By Lornette Daye

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Introduction from Lornette Daye

Welcome to the Finish Strong series.

As a former elite sprinter, Canadian National Team athlete, and coach, I know exactly what it feels like to stand on the starting line with the weight of the world on your shoulders. I know the sting of setbacks, the grind of daily discipline, and the pressure to perform at a world-class level.

But I also know the power of resilience, faith, and elite mental fortitude.

These materials are designed for you—the elite student-athlete navigating high-stakes environments, million-dollar NIL landscapes, global media scrutiny, and the immense pressure of expectation. Over the course of this journey, we will focus on building your identity, your brand equity, and your purpose beyond the scoreboard. My message to you is simple: no matter how the race begins, you have the power to Finish Strong.

Take time to reflect, prepare, and dominate. You are more than an athlete; you are a global enterprise and a leader.

Finish Strong,

Lornette Daye

Evaluating a Million-Dollar Deal

Top-tier athletes do not just sign contracts; they enter into strategic partnerships. Before attaching your globally recognized likeness to a corporation, you must analyze the deal from a position of power, not desperation.

Traditional Endorsement (Old Model)	Equity & Licensing (Elite 2026 Model)
Flat fee for 3 social media posts.	Base fee + fractional equity in the startup.
Perpetual use of your likeness.	Time-bound, tightly restricted likeness usage.
You promote their product.	You co-develop a signature product line.
Brand drops you if injured.	Multi-year guarantees tied to non-athletic deliverables.

REAL WORLD FACT:
In 2025, 40% of top collegiate draft prospects successfully renegotiated standard NIL contracts to include performance escalators and post-career advisory shares.

The Decision Matrix

Does this brand align with the 10-year vision of my personal enterprise?

What are the morality clauses, and how broadly are they defined?

If this product fails publicly, will it permanently damage my draft stock or brand equity?

Closing Encouragement

You have completed this portion of the Finish Strong journey!

Remember that the elite lessons you've learned are not just for your sport; they are for your life. The resilience, strategic discipline, and unshakeable faith you are building now will carry you through every major transition, every global challenge, and every victory that lies ahead.

Keep building your identity. Keep protecting your brand. Keep finishing strong.

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